

I'm seeking representation for *Sará*, completed at 93,000 words. It is a literary novel that braids two love stories across Venice and a Death Valley town. The book sits on the shelf with Hernan Diaz's *Trust* and A.S. Byatt's *Possession*.

In contemporary Venice, the novel's ostensible author falls in love with a Lamia. Meanwhile, a *marochinèra* named Chiara falls in love with the same Lamia. In the second act, the first-person author falls into a different love with a retired ER nurse, Callista, who has come west for reasons she does not at first explain. The two acts meet in the figure of the bookbinder who, years later, has been handed the materials of this book – irregular papers, conflicting drafts, an editor's contradictory notes, police records, a chapter that arrived empty – and is unhappy about what he is being asked to bind. The novel opens in a hardboiled metafictional register that it then dismantles. Chapter V appears as a printer's error. It is not one.

The text was written in the middle of an embodied OCD loop with AI assistance used as cognitive prosthesis. (AI usage fully disclosed and the source code on GitHub.) An elegy for the author's father, a scientist who collected and bound books. A self-replicating open source library that implements a coded letter to her daughter, who will receive the decryption key via trust agent at twenty-five. A memoir of transition, encoded so that the queer reader recognizes it and the cis reader passes through. The author believes it could represent a new paradigm in safe communication, live and in real time, between subjects of vastly different cultural backgrounds. Her employer is poised and waiting to see what her work produces for the #Pride and #LiftUpWomen ERGs, and is giving her time to do this creative work on company time.

My company is sending me to Pride Days in Chicago (June 28) and I plan to demonstrate this internally at that event. My framework is AI-facilitated D&D for feelings, for people who have no theoretical/critical lenses or interest in dragons, the LLM supplies the infinite library of myth and paratextual criticism. Replicable, with a small Docker container published on Github so the adoption curve is low.

I am a senior data engineer with thirty-five years in software, a former student of Louise Glück, former student and research assistant of Mark C. Taylor, former student of Larry Swain in Old English, and a performer of Old English and Venetian verse. I live in Beatty, Nevada. This is my first novel.

— Calliope Ariana Tweney

fka Christopher Alan Tweney

aka Callie CAT ;-}

<https://github.com/Calliehub/sara>

<https://github.com/Calliehub/beodata>